THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

SOLUTION MINDSET

8 Ways to Develop a Problem-Solving Mind

Every problem is an invitation to become more capable.

PROBLEM SOLVING

COURSE WORKBOOK

ZEKI UBOR

Founder, The Becoming Institute

www.origin.com.ng

INTRODUCTION | The Problem Solver's Advantage

In a world that changes faster than ever before, one skill separates those who thrive from those who survive: the ability to solve problems. Not just simple problems — complex, ambiguous, multi-layered problems that have no obvious answer.

The Becoming Institute defines a Solution Mindset as the trained habit of approaching every challenge with systematic curiosity, creative analysis, and decisive action. It is not a personality trait. It is a skill set — and this course teaches it.

This workbook is your active companion. Work through each section, complete the exercises, and apply the frameworks to real challenges in your life. The goal is not to read — it is to transform.

> *"The measure of intelligence is the ability to change." — Albert Einstein*
> *"Every problem is a gift — without problems, we would not grow." — Tony Robbins*

THE 8 WAYS FRAMEWORK — OVERVIEW

1. Define the Problem Precisely
Most people solve the wrong problem. Define it with surgical clarity before touching solutions.

2. Apply Root Cause Analysis
Use the 5-Whys method to dig beneath symptoms to the actual source of any problem.

3. Reframe the Problem
Shift your angle. "Why is this failing?" becomes "What would need to be true for this to succeed?"

4. Generate Multiple Solutions
Force yourself to produce at least 10 options before evaluating any. Quantity first, quality second.

5. Use Analytical Frameworks
SWOT, Decision Matrix, Fishbone, Force Field — match the right tool to the problem type.

6. Apply Creative Thinking
Use SCAMPER, analogy thinking, and lateral thinking to break beyond conventional solutions.

7. Test and Iterate
Small, fast experiments beat grand plans. Prototype, learn, refine.

8. Learn From Every Outcome
Document every problem solved. Build your personal library of solutions.

WORKSHEET 1 | SWOT Analysis for Your Current Challenge

Write your current challenge or goal: _____

STRENGTHS (What advantages do you have?)	WEAKNESSES (What is holding you back?)
OPPORTUNITIES (What could you leverage?)	THREATS (What risks exist?)

WORKSHEET 2 | The 5-Whys Root Cause Finder

Problem Statement: _____

Why 1:

Why 2:

Why 3:

Why 4:

Why 5:

ROOT CAUSE: _____

MODULE | CRITICAL THINKING & COGNITIVE BIAS AUDIT

- Confirmation bias: Only seeing what confirms existing beliefs
- Anchoring: Over-relying on the first piece of information
- Availability heuristic: Overweighting recent or memorable events
- Dunning-Kruger: Overestimating your competence in unfamiliar areas
- Sunk cost fallacy: Continuing because of past investment, not future value

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Apply this module to a real current challenge. What did you discover?

What is one thing you will do differently based on this module?

MODULE | CREATIVE PROBLEM SOLVING — SCAMPER METHOD

- S — Substitute: What can be replaced?
- C — Combine: What can be merged or joined?
- A — Adapt: What can be modified to fit another context?
- M — Modify/Magnify: What can be amplified or reduced?
- P — Put to other uses: How else could this be used?
- E — Eliminate: What can be removed entirely?
- R — Reverse/Rearrange: What if the order or direction was flipped?

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Apply this module to a real current challenge. What did you discover?

What is one thing you will do differently based on this module?

MODULE | DECISION MAKING UNDER PRESSURE

- The Pre-mortem: Imagine it has failed. Why? Work backwards to prevent it.
- Satisficing: Sometimes "good enough" is the optimal choice given constraints.
- Decision journal: Document the reasoning behind each major decision.
- The 10/10/10 Rule: How will you feel about this in 10 min, 10 months, 10 years?
- Reversibility test: Is this a one-way or two-way door? Two-way doors need less analysis.

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Apply this module to a real current challenge. What did you discover?

What is one thing you will do differently based on this module?

MODULE | COLLABORATIVE PROBLEM SOLVING

- Establish psychological safety: People only share ideas where it is safe to be wrong.
- Diverge before converging: Generate all ideas before evaluating any of them.
- Assign a devil's advocate: Deliberately challenge the group consensus.
- Document reasoning, not just conclusions: Track why decisions were made.
- Celebrate problem-finding as much as problem-solving.

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Apply this module to a real current challenge. What did you discover?

What is one thing you will do differently based on this module?

30-DAY SOLUTION MINDSET PRACTICE PLAN

Week 1 — Awareness

- Day 1-3: Document every problem you encounter. Define each one precisely.
- Day 4-5: Apply 5-Whys to your biggest current challenge.
- Day 6-7: Complete the SWOT worksheet for a goal you are pursuing.

Week 2 — Frameworks

- Day 8-10: Use the Decision Matrix for one pending decision.
- Day 11-12: Apply SCAMPER to one thing in your life you want to improve.
- Day 13-14: Reframe 3 problems using alternative perspectives.

Week 3 — Creative Expansion

- Day 15-17: Brainstorm 10+ solutions before choosing any.
- Day 18-19: Practice lateral thinking with a daily creativity prompt.
- Day 20-21: Teach the 5-Whys to someone in your household or team.

Week 4 — Integration

- Day 22-25: Apply the complete framework to a major life challenge.
- Day 26-28: Review decisions made this month. What would you do differently?
- Day 29-30: Write your Problem-Solving Manifesto — your personal approach.

MY SOLUTION MINDSET COMMITMENT

Complete this section. Sign it. Return to it weekly.

The biggest problem I commit to solving in the next 30 days:

The framework I will use and why:

My accountability partner (name) and check-in date:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

Transforming Individuals. Building Leaders. Shaping Generations.

Founder: Zeki Ubor | www.origin.com.ng

This workbook accompanies the "8 Ways to Develop Solution Mindset" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

Continue your journey at www.origin.com.ng

Official Origin Course Workbook | 8 Ways to Develop Solution Mindset

Downloaded from the Origin Learning Platform | www.origin.com.ng